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TRANSPORTATION



Ex-Waymo engineers launch Bedrock Robotics with \$80M to automate construction

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IMAGE CREDITS: BEDROCK ROBOTICS

Bedrock is the latest company to steer engineers

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Robotics, Seattle-based Overland AI, New Brunswick, Canada-based Potential, and more established companies like Forterra.

Bedrock said it's focused on construction sites and is testing in Arkansas, Arizona, Texas, and California with four corporations: Sundt Construction, Zachry Construction Corporation, Champion Site Prep Inc., and Capitol Aggregates Inc.

TE

Tech and VC heavyweights join the Disrupt 2025 agenda

Netflix, ElevenLabs, Wayve, Sequoia Capital — just a few of the heavy hitters joining the Disrupt 2025 agenda. They're here to deliver the insights that fuel startup growth and sharpen your edge. Don't miss the 20th anniversary of TechCrunch Disrupt, and a chance to learn from the top voices in tech — grab your ticket now and save up to \$675 before prices rise on August 7.

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Former Anki engineers
will steer Waymo's self-
driving trucks effort

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Anki built several popular products, starting with Anki Drive in 2013 and later the popular Cozmo robot. The Bay Area-startup had shipped more than 3.5 million devices with annual revenues approaching \$100 million, Sofman wrote Thursday in a LinkedIn post.

Anki had raised more than \$180 million, according to Crunchbase. The company was apparently prepared to take its robots business beyond entertainment, but it ran out of runway before it was able to activate that plan. “In the end we couldn’t overcome recent hurdles and the complexities of consumer hardware,” Sofman wrote.

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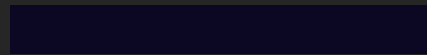
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“Throughout the last decade, I would look over at what was happening at Waymo and be inspired by

the progress they were making, and the inevitable impact their technology would have on everyone's lives in the years to come," Sofman wrote.

The trucking team will work out of Waymo's San Francisco office, a newer development within the company's structure.

Much of the attention on Waymo has been on its robotaxi ambitions and its Waymo One ride-hailing service in the Phoenix area. However, the company has intentions to apply its full self-driving stack to other commercial applications, including trucks and deliveries.

"The nice thing about this is that it's a core technology that you're talking about. It's exactly what we've been talking about in our interview with Digital Commerce."

Topics:

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Postmates' self-driving

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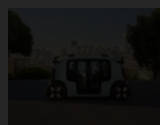
Postmates' cooler-inspired autonomous delivery robot, which will roll out commercially in Los Angeles later this year, will rely on lidar sensors from [Ouster](#), a burgeoning two-year-old startup that recently raised \$60 million in equity and debt funding.

Postmates unveiled the first generation of its self-described [“autonomous rover”](#) — known as Serve — late last year. The vehicle uses cameras and light detection and ranging sensors called lidar to navigate sidewalks, as well as a backup human

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TRANSPORTATION



Federal regulators give Zoox an exemption for its custom-built robotaxis

Kirsten Korosec
- 14 hours ago

who remotely monitors the rover and can take control if needed.

A new second-generation version made its debut onstage earlier this month at [Fortune's Brainstorm Tech event](#). This newer version looks identical to the original version except a few minor details, including a change in lidar sensors. The previous version was outfitted with sensors from Velodyne, a company that has long dominated the lidar industry.

The supplier contract is notable for Ouster, a startup trying to carve out market share from the giant Velodyne and stand out from a global pack of

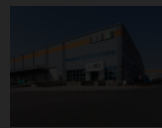
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Ouster's
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industries, including robotics, drones, mapping, defense, building security, mining and agriculture companies. It's an approach that Waymo is also pursuing for its [custom lidar sensors](#), which will be sold to companies outside of self-driving cars. Waymo will initially target robotics, security and agricultural technology.

Ouster's business model, along with its tech, has helped it land 437 customers to date and raise a total of \$90 million.

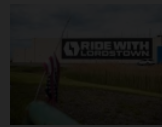
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Jeh Aerospace nets \$11M to scale the commercial aircraft supply chain in India

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(CMOS)

tech found in consumer digital cameras and smartphones. The company has announced four lidar sensors to date, with resolutions from 16 to 128 channels, and two product lines, the OS-1 and OS-2.

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